

AN1.11 - Credit Ledger (A9)

Sprint: AT24 AI Agents - Agent Framework Foundation **Step:** A9 - the agent Credit Ledger (real accounting, not a counter) **Depends on:** A3 persistence, A4 runtime, A8 authorization (all closed) **Gate:** G09 - **CLOSED / APPROVED**. Migration **applied under G09 authorization**.

Post-apply verification (live DB)

`prisma migrate deploy` -> "Applying migration 20260907120000_add_agent_credit_ledger ... All migrations successfully applied."

Check	Found
<code>enum AgentCreditEntryKind</code>	present
<code>table AgentCreditLedgerEntry</code>	present
unique index <code>AgentCreditLedgerEntry_idempotencyKey_key</code>	present (UNIQUE)
indexes	<code>(userId, periodStart), (runId), (userId, createdAt) + pkey</code>
billing tables (Billing / Subscription / Plan)	intact (3/3)
<code>_prisma_migrations</code> row	present, finished
<code>prisma migrate status</code>	"Database schema is up to date"
<code>prisma generate</code>	succeeds
real-persistence smoke (PrismaCreditStore)	<code>charge</code> -> entry; duplicate key -> <code>alreadyApplied: true</code> (idempotent); amount 200 vs balance 100 -> <code>InsufficientCreditsError</code> , no entry ; refund 10 -> -10 entry; <code>historyForRun</code> -> 2 entries; balance = <code>100 - 30 + 10 = 80</code>

The migration file keeps its review-time header (immutable once applied). **No credit wiring beyond the reservation/reconcile already in tick() was added.**

This is not `run.creditsConsumed += cost`. That field stays as the per-run *budget* counter feeding A8's `maxCreditCost` guardrail. A9 is a separate **accounting authority**: **Account (allowance)** -> immutable ledger -> **deterministic balance** -> run/tool correlation -> idempotent charge -> auditable history.

1. Budget vs accounting - the separation (owner's point 2)

	mechanism	owner
Budget / resource guardrail	<code>AgentRun.limits.maxCreditCost</code> - a per-run ceiling; <code>checkLimits()</code> denies a tool call that would cross it	A4 / A8
Entitlement / allowance	<code>PLAN_LIMITS[planId].aiCredits</code> for the billing period	<code>config/plan-limits.ts</code> (unchanged)

	mechanism	owner
Accounting authority	AgentCreditLedgerEntry - immutable entries; balance = allowance - $\Sigma(\text{entries this period})$ recomputed fresh	A9 (new)

A8 decides **whether authorized**. A9 decides **whether economically executable**. Neither absorbs the other - the runtime calls A8 `authorize()`, then A9 `charge()` (reservation), then the executor.

2. What was built - `services/agent-framework/credits/`

File	Role
<code>credit-store.ts</code>	CreditStore port (insert / findByIdempotencyKey / sumForPeriod / entriesForRun) + DuplicateLedgerEntryError. The ledger never touches Prisma directly.
<code>in-memory-credit-store.ts</code>	InMemoryCreditStore - tests + stand-in until the migration is applied.
<code>prisma-credit-store.ts</code>	PrismaCreditStore - the real AgentCreditLedgerEntry table; maps a Postgres unique-violation (P2002) to DuplicateLedgerEntryError.
<code>allowance-resolver.ts</code>	AllowanceResolver port + PlanAllowanceResolver (reads User.planId / active Subscription -> PLAN_LIMITS[plan].aiCredits + period bounds) + FixedAllowanceResolver (tests). No pricing logic.
<code>credit-ledger.ts</code>	CreditLedger - balance / canAfford / charge / refund / historyForRun; InsufficientCreditsError.
<code>index.ts</code>	barrel + createCreditLedger() (Prisma-backed; AGENT_CREDIT_INMEMORY=1 escape hatch for harnesses) + inMemoryCreditLedger().

2.1 CreditLedger semantics

```

balance(userId)      -> { allowance, consumed, balance } - allowance -  $\Sigma(\text{period entries})$ , NEVER cached
canAfford(userId, n) -> balance >= n
charge({ ..., amount, idempotencyKey })
  amount < 0          -> Error (use refund)
  idempotencyKey exists -> no-op, { alreadyApplied: true }, balance unchanged
  balance < amount     -> InsufficientCreditsError (deterministic; NO entry written; NO negative balance)
  otherwise            -> insert immutable entry { amount, balanceAfter, kind, runId, stepId?, toolCallId }
  concurrent duplicate race -> caught (unique key), treated as alreadyApplied
refund({ ..., amount, idempotencyKey }) -> a signed (negative-amount) entry, kind "refund"
historyForRun(runId) -> every charge/refund for the run, ordered, fully attributed

```

2.2 Runtime integration - reservation + reconcile (no double-charge on resume)

doRunningSlice, per plan step:

```

1. authorizationService.authorize(...) (A8) deny -> terminate
2. creditLedger.charge({ amount: estimate, idempotencyKey: `${runId}:step${planIndex}:reserve` }) (A9 RESERVE, BEFORE the executor)
   InsufficientCreditsError -> terminate credit_limit / insufficient_credits
3. invokeTool(...) (executor)
4. reconcile: actual = ToolResult.creditsConsumed
   actual > estimate -> charge `${runId}:step${planIndex}:topup`
   actual < estimate -> refund `${runId}:step${planIndex}:refund`

```

```

    (A2 tools are flat-cost -> delta 0 -> no reconcile)
5. run.creditsConsumed += actual          (the A8 budget counter, unchanged)
6. advance nextPlanIndex; persist

```

Idempotency keys are derived from (runId, plan step index), never from a fresh toolCallId. A tick that dies after the reserve but before advancing nextPlanIndex re-runs the same step on resume: the reserve charge() hits the existing key -> alreadyApplied no-op. **A read tool may re-execute on a mid-tick crash; it is never re-charged.**

3. Persistence - AgentCreditLedgerEntry (migration GENERATED, NOT APPLIED)

prisma/schema.prisma: +1 enum AgentCreditEntryKind (tool_call, model_inference, research_search, backtest, optimization, large_context, refund, adjustment), +1 model:

```

AgentCreditLedgerEntry
  id, userId, runId, stepId?, toolCallId?, kind,
  amount      (signed: + debit, - refund),
  balanceAfter (advisory - computed at write time; recompute for authority),
  idempotencyKey @unique <- the double-charge guard,
  reason, periodStart, createdAt
  @@index([userId, periodStart]) <- the period-sum query
  @@index([runId])               <- historyForRun
  @@index([userId, createdAt])

```

Append-only, immutable - no updatedAt, no deletedAt, no update path.

Migration 20260907120000_add_agent_credit_ledger/migration.sql - **GENERATED via prisma migrate diff (offline), hand-reviewed, header marks it NOT APPLIED.** Purely additive: 1 enum + 1 table, no DROP, no ALTER TABLE, never references an existing table.

4. G09 proof - npm run validate:agent-credit -> 13 passed, 0 failed

balance = allowance – ledger sum, recomputed every call	■
canAfford = balance >= amount	■
charge : atomic debit; immutable entry with balanceAfter + runId/kind/reason/toolCallId	■
IDEMPOTENT : same idempotencyKey -> no-op, balance unchanged, one entry	■
NO NEGATIVE BALANCE : over-budget charge -> InsufficientCreditsError, no entry written , balance untouched	■
charge rejects a negative amount (use refund)	■
refund : signed negative-amount entry raises the balance	■
historyForRun : every charge/refund, ordered, fully attributed (kind, amount, toolCallId, reason)	■
generated AgentCreditEntryKind enum == AF-v1 vocabulary	■
PlanAllowanceResolver: unknown user -> free plan's aiCredits (PLAN_LIMITS.free.aiCredits)	■
migration present; NOT APPLIED; additive-only; unique idempotencyKey index	■

RUNTIME: allowance 1, 2-tool plan -> 1st tool reserves 1 (balance 0), 2nd reservation fails -> run terminates <code>credit_limit / insufficient_credits</code> (A9, distinct from A8); <code>historyForRun</code> shows exactly 1 charge	■
RUNTIME: a well-funded run, a lost tick between reserve and advance -> resume charges exactly once per tool call (idempotent reservation)	■

4.1 Auditability - given a run, `historyForRun(runId)` answers

what was charged - for which tool (`toolCallId` + `reason`) - when (`createdAt`) - why (`reason`) - how much (`amount`) - was it retried (an `alreadyApplied` no-op leaves one entry) - was it refunded (a negative kind: `"refund"` entry) - resulting balance (`balanceAfter` + a fresh `balance()` recompute agree).

4.2 Regression - no gate lost

`validate:agent-contracts` 38/0 - `validate:agent-tools` 20/0 - `validate:agent-run-persistence` 17/0 - `validate:agent-runtime` 9/0 - `validate:agent-supervisor` 11/0 - `validate:agent-integrity` 21/0 - `validate:agent-memory` 19/0 - `validate:agent-authorization` 17/0 - `validate:agent-credit` **13/0**. (The 4 runtime-exercising harnesses set `AGENT_CREDIT_INMEMORY=1` so they never write real ledger rows.)

5. TypeScript

`npx tsc --noEmit`: **0 errors** in the framework code + the new `AgentCreditLedgerEntry` model. Repo-wide 77, all in the stale generated `.next/dev/types/validator.ts` (gitignored, pre-existing).

6. Files changed

Added (7):

```
frontend/services/agent-framework/credits/credit-store.ts
frontend/services/agent-framework/credits/in-memory-credit-store.ts
frontend/services/agent-framework/credits/prisma-credit-store.ts
frontend/services/agent-framework/credits/allowance-resolver.ts
frontend/services/agent-framework/credits/credit-ledger.ts
frontend/services/agent-framework/credits/index.ts
frontend/prisma/migrations/20260907120000_add_agent_credit_ledger/migration.sql (GENERATED + REVIEWED, NOT
frontend/scripts/validate-agent-credit.ts
```

Modified (5):

```
frontend/types/agent-framework/agent-run-contract.ts + AgentCreditEntryKind + AgentCreditLedgerEntry shape
frontend/prisma/schema.prisma + 1 enum, 1 model (appended)
frontend/services/agent-framework/runtime/agent-runtime.ts reservation-charge before the executor; reconcili
frontend/scripts/validate-agent-{runtime,supervisor,integrity,authorization}.ts + AGENT_CREDIT_INMEMORY=1
frontend/package.json + "validate:agent-credit"
```

Not touched: `services/billing/*` / `EntitlementService` / `aiMessages entitlement` (pool-unification is a deliberate follow-on), `contracts A1-A8 behaviour`, `legacy agents UI`. No API routes. No pricing change.

7. Non-goals honoured

- **No pricing change** - per-tool amounts are the placeholder costs the `ToolGateway` already computes; the ledger records whatever it's given.

- No pool-unification with the `aiMessages` billing entitlement (out of scope, `services/billing/*` is off-limits per L2.5).
 - No queue/worker - the resumable `tick()` model is unchanged.
 - No new agents / tools / engines / UI.
 - `run.creditsConsumed` is **not** the ledger - it stays as the budget counter.
-

8. Status

A9 complete. The credit ledger is a real, immutable, idempotent, auditable accounting authority. The runtime reserves credits before the executor and reconciles after; a resumed tick never double-charges; a run that can't afford its next tool call terminates `credit_limit / insufficient_credits`. Migration is generated + reviewed, **not applied**.

G09 review requested - schema + `migration.sql` + the ledger. On acceptance -> authorize applying the A9 migration, then A10 (Evaluation + Observability).

End AN1.11.